SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #32 · WORTH AND CLASS

"Where I come from makes me less."

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Where it often comes from

A neighborhood, a family name, a region, an accent, or a family's history can be treated as a mark against us. Teasing, being passed over, or feeling like an outsider at school or work can leave a lasting sense of being less. Some people try to hide where they came from, and others carry a quiet shame.

What Scripture teaches

When Philip told Nathanael about Jesus, Nathanael asked, "Can anything good come from Nazareth?" and Philip answered, "Come and see." God often brings good from small and overlooked places. David was the youngest son in the field, and Peter says that God does not show favoritism. The psalmist says that God knew us when we were woven together in secret, before anyone could attach a label to us. Our origin is not our value.

> *"'Can anything good come from Nazareth?' Nathanael asked. 'Come and see,' said Philip"* (John 1:46).

Also see

> "Then Peter began to speak: 'I now truly understand that God does not show favoritism.'" (Acts 10:34).

> "'Before I formed you in the womb I knew you, and before you were born I set you apart and appointed you as a prophet to the nations.'" (Jeremiah 1:5).

> "But God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong" (1 Corinthians 1:27).

> "My frame was not hidden from You when I was made in secret, when I was woven together in the depths of the earth" (Psalm 139:15).

Common self-statements

- People from where I come from do not amount to much.
- I should hide where I grew up.
- I will never fit in.
- My background is a mark against me.
- My accent gives me away.
- I come from nothing.

Common logical errors

- Stereotyping: Accepting someone else's label for my background.
- Overgeneralizing: Letting a few unkind experiences define the whole.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling ashamed and concluding that my background is shameful.
- Mental filter: Seeing only the disadvantages of my origins.

Challenging questions

- What was good about the place and people I come from?
- Who taught me to be ashamed, and what did they gain?

- What strengths did I develop because of where I grew up?
- What does God say about origins and worth?
- What would it look like to honor my background and still grow?
- Who could I tell my story to?

Truth summary

> Where I come from is part of my story, not a measure of my worth. Good can come from small places, and God knew me before anyone labeled me. I can tell my story with honesty and dignity.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Prejudice
- Guilt/Shame
- Humility
- Love, By God

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Judgmental

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

Hello My Name Is — Matthew West
God's redeemed-child identity challenges labels of regret and defeat.

Dear Younger Me — MercyMe
Past wounds and choices do not have to become a person's permanent identity.

How Great Thou Art — Jordan Smith
This classic hymn connects God's greatness, Christ's sacrifice, and future hope.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Where I come from makes me less"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Where I come from makes me less." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What was good about where I come from?
- ☐ Who taught me to feel ashamed?
- ☐ What strengths did I gain?
- ☐ What does God say about my origin?
- ☐ How can I honor my roots?
- ☐ Who can I tell my story to?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ My origin is not my worth.
- ☐ God knew me before I was born.
- ☐ Good can come from small places.
- ☐ My background gave me strengths.
- ☐ I can honor where I come from.
- ☐ I do not have to hide.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **John 1:46**
  "'Can anything good come from Nazareth?' Nathanael asked. 'Come and see,' said Philip."
- ☐ **Jeremiah 1:5**
  "'Before I formed you in the womb I knew you, and before you were born I set you apart and appointed you as a prophet to the nations.'"
- ☐ **Psalm 139:15**
  "My frame was not hidden from You when I was made in secret, when I was woven together in the depths of the earth."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] A strength from my roots: Each week, write one strength or value that comes from where you grew up.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, John 1:46 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Good can come from small places, and God knew me before anyone labeled me.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] List what was good. Write five good things about your family, community, or upbringing.
- [ ] Name the shame. Write what you were taught to feel ashamed of and who taught it.
- [ ] Tell your story. Share a part of your story with a trusted friend.
- [ ] Honor your roots. Do something that celebrates where you came from, such as a favorite food, a call, or a visit.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Where I come from makes me less": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A root I honor
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Where I come from makes me less.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You knew me before I was born. Free me from shame about where I come from. Help me see the good in my story and tell it with honesty and dignity. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.